



MAYA MINT

2007 Rs **52 crore**

ONE HOUSE IN DELHI:

Rs **18 crore**

COMMERCIAL PROPERTIES IN DELHI:

Rs **18.8 crore**

BANK INVESTMENTS AND FINANCES :

Rs **12.8 crore**

JEWELLERY: Rs **1 crore**

HOUSE IN LUCKNOW:

Rs **97.4 lakh**

CASH: Rs **50 lakh**

GOLD AND DIAMONDS:

Rs **49.7 lakh**

MURALS : Rs **15 lakh**

2004 Rs **12 crore**

FOUR HOUSES IN DELHI:

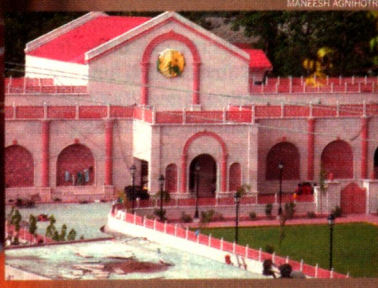
Rs **1.2 crore**

JEWELLERY: Rs **31 lakh**

CASH: Rs **1.5 lakh**

BANK INVESTMENTS AND FINANCES:

Rs **9.7 crore**



things, a house in Delhi's diplomatic area, Chanakyapuri, worth Rs 18 crore, commercial properties in the Capital's business district Connaught Place, diamonds and jewellery worth nearly Rs 1.5 crore (see box).

Four years ago, a similar controversy had haunted her shortly after she quit office and the CBI had then claimed to have documents to prove that she had amassed assets "disproportionate to her known sources of income". But in the years since, with political equations in Delhi under constant flux, the CBI predictably sat back. The draft for prosecution is still pending at CBI headquarters in Delhi and with her recent resounding victory in the polls, it would take more than a brave officer to reopen the files in any haste.

and telecasting "baseless news that was aimed at maligning her and her party's image".

Daughter of a government employee, Mayawati had wanted to become a civil servant, but settled for a job as a teacher in a government school. It was a chance meeting with Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) supremo Kanshi Ram that drew her to politics and BSP, which she joined in 1984.

Since then, she has not had to look back and though she has seen several ups and downs in politics, Mayawati has played her cards intelligently. Whichever side she has been on, she has made sure those on the other side also wooed her. Her firebrand style and acidic attacks on the Mulayam Singh government endeared her greatly to

the vast majority of people in Uttar Pradesh who were dismayed by the rule of coterie that Mulayam Singh ran.

Mayawati's political growth ran parallel to her growth from a rustic and garrulous state politician to one who could occupy centre stage in Delhi. She acquired a taste for the high life, began shopping for designer clothes and jewellery and felt as much at ease in the



THE RISING: Bungalow in Delhi

But her affidavit to contest the legislative council election has provided fresh ammunition to an already raging controversy. Shortly after she filed it, her opponents sought to put her on the mat for the issue.

Retaliation was both swift and aggressive. She targeted one TV news channel in particular, accusing it of getting prime land allotted in Noida at a throwaway price for its studio from the previous government headed by her bete noire Mulayam Singh Yadav. Characteristically, she went to the extent of threatening newspapers and TV channels if they "show or print" such "baseless" news. In the presence of senior bureaucrats and ministers, she threatened the media with swift retribution if they did not stop writing

state's hinterland as she was attending a luncheon at a five-star hotel in the Capital. Along the way, she also bought bungalows, commercial establishments, jewellery and precious murals.

When she became the chief minister for the fourth time on May 13, charges of corruption and misuse of authority that had haunted her in the previous three regimes refused to die down. Before quitting office after his defeat, Mulayam Singh had forwarded a file to Governor T.V. Rajeshwar for giving sanction to Mayawati's prosecution in the Taj Heritage case, being investigated by the CBI. The governor refused sanction and CBI's special court also rejected the plea of prosecution. It's just well. Because more than anyone else, Mayawati knows offence is the best defence. ■